

Gotabgaa Australia

Membership Payments & Tax Guide

Version 1.0 · June 2026 · For leadership & finance volunteers

Important: This document is general guidance for Australian community associations. It is **not legal or tax advice**. Confirm your obligations with a qualified accountant or tax agent based on your legal structure (incorporated association, charity, company, etc.).

1. Purpose

This guide explains how Gotabgaa Australia can collect **membership fees directly** (without third-party card processors such as Stripe or PayPal), and how to think about **GST, income tax, and record-keeping** in Australia.

It supports the website membership portal at `join.html` and the admin dashboard **Membership** section, where fees are adjustable and registrations can be exported as CSV.

2. Recommended payment method (Australia)

Primary recommendation: PayID + bank transfer (EFT)

For a community association that wants money paid **directly into the association's own bank account**, PayID and EFT are the simplest and most common approach in Australia.

Method	How it works	Notes
PayID	Member pays instantly using email, phone, or ABN linked to your business account	Very familiar in Australia; usually free for payer and receiver
Bank transfer (EFT)	Member transfers to your BSB + account number	Good backup; may take 1–2 business days
BPAY (optional later)	Member pays using biller code + reference	Requires biller setup with your bank; more admin to establish

Member payment flow (no Stripe)

Register online on `join.html`

- See fee + PayID / bank details + unique reference
- Member pays from their bank
- Treasurer checks bank account
- Admin marks registration as Paid in dashboard
- Send receipt to member (email)

What to set up with your bank

- **Business or community association bank account** (not a personal account)
- **PayID** linked to the association (e.g. official email or ABN)
- **BSB and account number** for members who prefer EFT
- Optional: **BPAY biller** if the chapter grows and wants bill-style payments

Payment reference format

Use a unique reference so you can match bank deposits to registrations, for example:

- `GAA-MEM-{registration-id}`
- `GAA-SURNAME-2026`

Store the reference in your admin registration record and on the member's payment instructions.

Methods not recommended as first choice

Method	Why defer or avoid initially
Stripe / PayPal	Third-party processor; fees; not "direct" to your account in the same way
Card payments on your own site	PCI compliance, fraud risk, merchant facility complexity
Cash only	Hard to audit; poor for interstate members
Personal bank account	Governance and tax risk; use association account only

Implementation phases

Phase	Actions
Phase 1 — Now	PayID + EFT; unique reference; admin marks paid; CSV export for records
Phase 2	BPAY biller; automated payment instruction email; optional receipt upload from member
Phase 3	Bank merchant / eftpos only if card payments become essential

3. Security & governance

- Publish bank details **only** on the official website ([join.html](#)) and in admin-published content.
- Use a **dedicated membership bank account**, separate from personal funds.
- Never ask members to pay to an individual's personal account unless that PayID is officially registered to the association.
- Maintain a simple ledger: registration ID, name, amount, date paid, payment method, who confirmed.
- Reconcile bank statements against admin registrations at least monthly.

4. Tax overview (Australia)

Tax treatment depends on how Gotabgaa Australia is legally structured. The following is a **general overview** — confirm with your accountant.

4.1 GST (Goods and Services Tax)

Membership fees are often treated as a supply of services to members.

Situation	Typical GST picture
Annual turnover under \$75,000	GST registration is usually optional ; many small associations do not register
Turnover \$75,000 or more	You generally must register for GST and lodge BAS statements
Registered charity (ACNC) with appropriate concessions	Some membership income may be GST-free — depends on structure and benefits provided
Not GST-registered	Do not charge 10% GST on fees; cannot claim GST credits on expenses
GST-registered and fee is taxable	May need to show GST clearly (e.g. \$50 + GST = \$55) — confirm with accountant

4.2 Income tax

- Not-for-profit status does **not** automatically mean zero tax.
- Small associations with limited income may have minimal income tax liability.
- ACNC-registered charities meeting ATO conditions may be **income tax exempt**.
- Non-charity incorporated associations may pay tax on certain non-member income (events, sponsorship) depending on structure.

4.3 ABN (Australian Business Number)

Operate with an **ABN** for:

- Bank account in the association's name
- Receipts and payment instructions
- PayID linked to the organisation
- Transparency for members and auditors

4.4 DGR and donations

Standard **membership fees** are usually not tax-deductible for members. **Donations** may be deductible only if the organisation has DGR (deductible gift recipient) status — ask your accountant.

5. Operational record-keeping

For each membership payment, record:

- ☐ Member full name
- ☐ Registration ID (from website admin)
- ☐ Email and phone
- ☐ Membership type and state/chapter
- ☐ Fee amount and currency
- ☐ Fee display text at time of registration (snapshot)
- ☐ Date payment received
- ☐ Payment method (PayID / EFT / BPAY)
- ☐ Bank reference used by member
- ☐ Membership period covered (e.g. calendar year 2026)
- ☐ Who confirmed payment in admin
- ☐ Payment status: pending → paid

Membership receipt (recommended content)

- Association legal name and **ABN**
- Member name
- Amount received
- Membership period (e.g. "Annual membership 2026")
- Date of payment
- Statement whether GST is included or not applicable
- Contact email for queries

Annual finance review

1. Reconcile bank account vs admin registration export (CSV)
2. Check whether GST registration is required for the new financial year
3. Prepare summary for AGM / board
4. Provide figures to accountant for tax return if required

6. Website integration (current & suggested)

Feature	Status / recommendation
Public join portal (<code>join.html</code>)	Live — members register online
Adjustable membership fee in admin	Live — publish after fee changes
Payment status <code>pending</code>	Live — ready for manual confirmation
Admin view + CSV export	Live — for treasurer and AGM reporting
PayID / BSB / account in CMS	Suggested — admin-editable payment instructions
Auto payment reference on registration	Suggested — e.g. <code>GAA-MEM-{id}</code>
Admin “Mark as paid” button	Suggested — updates <code>payment_status</code>
ABN + GST note on receipts	Suggested — editable in admin
Receipt email after payment confirmed	Suggested — Phase 2

7. Questions for your accountant

Copy and send these to a qualified Australian accountant or tax agent:

1. Gotabgaa Australia is a [incorporated association / other]. We collect annual membership fees via PayID and bank transfer. Should we register for GST?
2. Are our membership fees GST-free or taxable in our specific case?
3. Do we need to issue tax invoices for membership payments?
4. What records must we keep for the ATO and our AGM?
5. Are we eligible for income tax exemption or ACNC-related concessions?
6. Do membership fees vs donations need separate accounting treatment?

8. Common starting setup for community chapters

1. Incorporated association (state-based registration)
2. ABN registered to the association
3. Not GST-registered while turnover remains under \$75,000 (confirm annually)

- 4. PayID + EFT for membership fees
- 5. Admin dashboard + CSV for registration records
- 6. Annual accountant review

9. Document control

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Version	1.0
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